

# **OFFICE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (OIT)**

## **Policies and Procedures Manual**

### **1.2. Password / Passphrase Security Policy**

#### **1.2. . Purpose**

- 1.2.1. To provide a mechanism to maximize the security of information stored on University technology through the appropriate use of passwords / passphrases. Both words (passwords and passphrases) will be used interchangeably in this policy, but are two separate terms.
- 1.2.2. Passwords are assigned to each individual as a method to control and monitor their unique access to systems and information, and should never be shared with others.

#### **1.3. Policy**

- 1.3.1. Passwords will be changed frequently, currently every six months.
- 1.3.2. Users must change their password immediately upon the suspicion or knowing it has been compromised.
- 1.3.3. Users must immediately report any suspicious or suspect activity involving their accounts or other activity to the Help Desk.
- 1.3.4. Users are not to give others access to systems or information by providing them with their account and password at any time.
- 1.3.5. Users will be held individually responsible for the actions of others if they have knowingly shared their password and access with them.

#### **1.3.6. Procedure**

- 1.3.7. Where possible, the Office of Information Technology (OIT) will implement automatic password expiration processes to ensure passwords are changed on a regular and timely basis.
- 1.3.8. Where possible, OIT will implement password complexity rules on each system. However, if not possible, passwords should adhere to the following:
  - 1.3.8.1. Make each password unique – do not use the same password for multiple accounts or systems;

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- 1.3.8.2. Make the password at least 8 characters long (the longer the better);
- 1.3.8.3. Use at least one number (0-9);
- 1.3.8.4. Use at least one upper (A-Z) and one lower case (a-z) letter;
- 1.3.8.5. Use at least one symbol (!, #, \$, ^) that the system supports
- 1.3.8.6. Do not use standard words that would be listed in a dictionary (even non-American English words);
- 1.3.8.7. Do not use simple transformations of words such as Tiny8 or 7Eleven or alphabetic or numeric sequences such as abcdef or 12345
- 1.3.8.8. Do not use any personally identifiable information or passwords or phrases that may be easy to guess;
- 1.3.8.9. Use long passphrases instead of small overly complex passwords. For example 'Another1longpass!'

### **1.4. Enforcement**

- 1.4.1. Violations of any part of this policy may result in disciplinary action as prescribed by University policies and procedures.

### **1.5. Approval and adoption**

- 1.5.1. Approved by the Chief Information Officer and Executive Vice President and adopted effective 10/15/2002.
- 1.5.2. Updated to accurately reflect current password requirements and standards used in Active Directory. Reviewed and approved by the Chief Information Officer and Vice President for Facilities & Technology Services and adopted effective 11/1/2017.
- 1.5.3. Updated of terminology and technologies and move approvals to the end of document. Reviewed by Senior Directors of Infrastructure and Enterprise Applications, and CIO and adopted effective 7/1/2020.
- 1.5.4. Reviewed by AVPs of Infrastructure and Systems, Enterprise Applications, and CIO with no changes made as of 7/1/2023.